Policy Title	**Partners of the Americas' A Ganar Youth Safeguarding and Protection Policy**
Purpose/Goal	Partners of the Americas and its affiliates (referred to as "Partners") are committed to providing a safe and nurturing environment for all youth who participate in events sponsored by the organization. This policy is intended to provide guidelines and best practices for promoting and maintaining a safe and secure environment in all interactions with youth while assuring all representatives of the Partners of the Americas are acting responsibly to protect youth. The goal of this policy is to provide an environment that is safe and secure for participants in all A Ganar events, programs, and activities, wherever they occur. It further seeks to minimize the possibility for physical and sexual abuse of youth.
Compliance	All of those listed in the section below are required to comply with this policy. Partners affirms this policy and will not tolerate any abuse. This policy does not preclude the reporting of suspected abuse occurring outside of this policy and it applies to all A Ganar groups, activities and events.
Those who must comply with this policy	The following people must comply withthe A Ganar Youth Safeguarding and Protection Policy: ○ All staff, full time, part time, international and national, and those engaged on short-term contracts, e.g. consultants, facilitators, mentors, sub-contractors, researchers etc. (referred to as "staff"); ○ Volunteers, board members, trustees (referred to as "representatives"); ○ Staff and representatives of partner agencies and any other individuals, groups or organizations who have a formal/contractual relationship to Partners of the Americas that includes any type of involvement with the A Ganar program- unless it has been agreed under the global guidance and local procedures that the partner organization may enforce its own safeguarding or protection policy (referred to as "staff of implementing organization")
Definition of children or youth	Youth under this policy is anyone between the ages of 14 and 26.
Definition of Abuse	Abuse is defined as any sexual contact, indecent exposure, or communication for immoral purposes as well as physical abuses such as corporal punishment or physical assault.
Types of Abuse	1. Physical abuse is non-accidental injury, which is intentionally inflicted upon a youth. 2. Sexual abuse perpetrated by an adult is any non-consentual contact or activity of a sexual nature that occurs between a youth and an adult. This includes any activity, which is meant to arouse or gratify the sexual desires of the adult or youth. 3. Sexual abuse perpetrated by another youth is any contact or activity of a sexual nature that occurs between two youth when there is no consent, when consent is not possible, or when one youth has power over the other youth. This includes any activity which is meant to arouse or gratify the sexual desires of any of the youth. 4. Emotional abuse is mental or emotional injury to a youth that results in an observable and material impairment in the youth's growth, development or

	psychological functioning. 5. Neglect is the failure to provide for a youth's basic needs or the failure to make a reasonable effort to protect a youth from harm. 6. Economic exploitation is the deliberate misplacement, exploitation, or wrongful temporary or permanent use of a youth's belongings or money.
Responsibilities, Procedures and Practices	
Responsibilities	1. Personnel are prohibited from the use, possession, distribution, or being under theinfluence of alcohol, illegal drugs, or the misuse of legal drugs while participating in or assisting with A Ganar programs or activities. 2. Personnel will respond to youth with respect, consideration and equal treatment, regardless of sex, race, religion, sexual orientation, culture or socio- economic status. 3. Personnel will portray a positive role model for youth by maintaining an attitude of respect, patience, and maturity. They will avoid even the appearance of favoritism. 4. One-to-one counseling with youth will be done in an open or public or other place where private conversations are possible but occur in full view of others. 5. Personnel are prohibited from dating or becoming romantically involved with a youth while the youth is enrolled in the A Ganar program. 6. Personnel are prohibited from having sexual contact with a youth while the youth is enrolled in the A Ganar program. 7. Personnel are prohibited from possessing any sexually oriented materials (magazines, cards, videos, films, clothing etc.) on organization property or in the presence of youth except as expressly permitted as part of a pre-authorized educational program. 8. Personnel are prohibited from using the Internet to view or download any sexually oriented materials on CCO or IO property or where A Ganar training is held in the presence of youth. 9. Personnel are prohibited from discussing their own sexual activities, including dreams and fantasies, or discussing their use of sexually oriented or explicit materials such as pornography, videos or materials on or from the Internet, with youth. 10. Personnel are prohibited from dressing, undressing, bathing, or showering in the presence of youth. 11. Personnel are prohibited from using physical punishment in any way for behavior management of youth. No form of physical discipline is acceptable. This prohibition includes spanking, slapping, pinching, hitting, or any other physical force. Physical force may only be used to stop a behavior that may cause immediate harm to the individual or to others .
Procedures	1. Personnel must be physically present during all activities. 2. When supervising or assisting private activities such as dressing or showering youth, personnel will remain in an area observable by other adults.

Screening and Selection	
Personnel who regularly work with or around youth	Shall be screened and selected utilizing at least the following where possible: a. A STANDARD APPLICATION completed by the applicant that includes an authorization for the release of information to conduct background checks and the CODE OF CONDUCT (Appendix C). b. CRIMINAL RECORDS CHECK in any placewhere the applicant has resided during thepast seven (7) years, and other locations, if any, as determined by the company. c. SEXUAL OFFENDER REGISTRY CHECK in any place where the applicant has resided during the past seven (7) years. d. INDIVIDUAL INTERVIEW with the applicant. e. REFERENCE CHECKS of persons outside the organization who know the applicant, preferably who know how the applicant works with youth. f. DRIVING OR MOTOR VEHICLE RECORDS CHECK if the person will be transporting youth.
Personnel who occasionally work with or around youth	Shall be screened and selected utilizing at least the following where possible: a. A STANDARD APPLICATION completed by the applicant that includes an acknowledgment for the release of information to conduct background checks and the CODE OF CONDUCT (Appendix C). b. INDIVIDUAL INTERVIEW with the applicant. c. AT LEAST ONE REFERENCE CHECK of a person or persons outside of Partners of the Americas who know the applicant, preferably who know how the applicant interacts with youth. e. DRIVING OR MOTOR VEHICLE RECORDS CHECK if the person will be transporting youth.
Requirements	Prior to interacting with youth, the following steps need to be taken: • Complete Application (Appendix D) • Attend training as frequently as Partners deems necessary.
Education and Training Requirements	As part of the Training of Trainers (TOT), a child abuse prevention training will be provided. Participants in the TOT are then expected to train any other person who will teach or work with, any A Ganar participants. Two hours of child abuse prevention education and training is required for all PERSONNEL WHO REGULARLY WORK WITH OR AROUND YOUTH before they start their work youth or, if that is not possible, one hour of child abuse awareness training before they start their work and the rest of the training within three months of starting. One hour of child abuse awareness education and training is required for all PERSONNEL WHO OCCASIONALLY WORK WITH YOUTH before they start their work with children or youth. Personnel who are responsible for screening, selection and supervision of others in programs working with youth are required to complete an additional two (2) hours of
Education and	

Training Requirements continued	specialized education and training in screening, selection and monitoring every two years. Re-training will be required every two years to continue service with youth. A Ganar Headquarters staff and/or Country Coordinating Organizations are required to: - Present A Ganar Youth Participant Safeguarding and Protection Policy Training - Maintain individual confidential records that include: • Who has attended training and the date of attendance • Process the 2 referrals for those who attended the training • Review for completeness and compliance, the initial and updated(every two years) applications
Responding to Problems	A. REPORTING INAPPROPRIATE BEHAVIORS OR POLICY VIOLATIONS WITH YOUTH 1. When Personnel observe any inappropriate behaviors, behaviors that are inconsistent with the GUIDELINES FOR APPROPRIATE AFFECTION, or which may violate any provision of these Policies the for Protection of Youth from Abuse, they must immediately report their observations. Examples of inappropriate behaviors or policy violations would be seeking private time with youth, taking youth on over-night trips without other adults, swearing or making suggestive comments to youth, or selecting or using staff or volunteers without the required screening. 2. Such inappropriate behaviors or possible policy violations that relate to interactions with youth should be reported in one of the following ways: a. A telephone call/e-mail or meeting with your Regional Coordinator and the Program Director; b. Submit a NOTICE OF CONCERN (Appendix F), signed or unsigned, to your Regional Coordinator and to the Program Director. 3. All reports of inappropriate behavior or policy violations with youth will be taken seriously.
Communication	If there is an incident or tragedy in a country or program you support, you are not to send communications, including e-mails, to employees, donors, participants or others involved in the program about the incident. "Incident" as defined here includes not just instances of abuse but also violence, suicide, accident, or other trauma. All details concerning the incident are to be provided to your Regional Coordinator and the A Ganar Program Director and they will issue communication to the appropriate parties. The Regional Coordinator/Program Director may interact with Communications and/or Senior Management, as well as legal and human resources counsel, in the development for materials for any of the above described situations.
Appropriate interaction with	Some POSITIVE and APPROPRIATE forms of affection are listed below: • Brief hugs and kisses on the cheek.

Youth	• Pats on the shoulder or back. • Handshakes. • "High-fives" and hand slapping. • Verbal praise. • Arms around shoulders.		
Inappropriate interaction with Youth	The following are forms of INAPPROPRIATE behavior with youth. • Inappropriate or lengthy embraces. • Kisses on the mouth. • Touching bottoms, chests or genital areas. • Holding hands. • Showing affection in isolated areas • Occupying a bed with a youth. • Dancing innapropriately. • Touching knees or legs of youth. • Wrestling with youth. • Tickling youth. • Piggyback rides. • Any type of massage given by a youth to an adult. • Any type of massage given by an adult to a youth. • Any form of unwanted affection. • Comments or compliments (spoken, written, or electronic) that relate to physique or body development. • Snapping bras or giving wedgies or similar touch of underwear whether or not it is covered by other clothing. • Giving gifts or money to individual youth. • Private meals with youth.		
Core Policy Area:	Youth Safeguarding	Related Policies:	
Policy Owner:		Date of Approval:	
Reviewed:	Annually	Approved By:	
Related Forms:	Appendix A: Declaration of Acceptance Appendix B: Code of Conduct Appendix C: Application Appendix D: Reference Appendix E: Form For Notice of Concern Appendix F: Report of an Incident Appendix G: Training materials for annual training Appendix H: Background/DMV Appendix I: Acknowledgement		